

Linux to power the future of connected cars

The Linux Foundation has partnered with tech giants to bring out a specific Linux distribution built for the connected cars of the future.



The collaborative open source project, Automotive Grade Linux (AGL), has just added tech companies like Movimonto, Oracle, Qualcomm Innovation Center, Texas Instruments and UIEvolution to its board to boost the ongoing developments in connected cars.

The project was

originally announced in September 2012, but a clearer picture of this alliance was shaped at the Consumer Electronics Show (CES) earlier this year.

Automakers such as Ford, Mazda and Mitsubishi were already planning to integrate Linux into some of their future connected car models. However, the newly emerged development from Oracle, Qualcomm and Texas Instruments suggests that a UNIX-like operating system could play a vital role in transforming the automobile market as a whole.

“AGL has seen tremendous growth over the past year as demand for connected car technology and infotainment is rapidly increasing,” said Dan Cauchy, general manager of the automotive division at The Linux Foundation.

“Our membership base is not only growing rapidly, but it is also diversifying across various business interests, from semiconductors and in-vehicle software to IoT and connected cloud services. This is a clear indication that the connected car revolution has broad implications across many industry verticals,” Cauchy added.

The Linux Foundation recently developed a new AGL Unified Code Base (UCB) distribution that specifically targeted the automotive industry. The distribution was announced at the CES in January with features like real-time navigation, communication, safety, security and infotainment. Moreover, it includes a mix of components from AGL, Tizen and related open source code.

According to a report by research firm Gartner, there will be a quarter of a billion connected vehicles on the road by 2020. Linux would be one of the leading platforms in the market, while Google’s Android might also capture a decent share with its Android Auto offering.

Google’s Nest Labs announces OpenThread to expand IoT presence

Google-owned Nest Labs has announced the release of its open source OpenThread networking protocol. The new development is aimed to expand the presence of Nest’s IoT solutions, and is apparently a move to counter other

Ubuntu Make 16.05 released with updated Android Studio

Ubuntu Make 16.05 is the new version of the open source CLI tool that enables Android developments on the Ubuntu platform.



Days after the arrival of Ubuntu 16.04 LTS (Xenial Xerus), developers have now also got Ubuntu Make 16.05. The new version comes with an updated Android Studio and is preloaded with a tweaked Android SDK.

Didier Roche, the developer behind Ubuntu Make, announced the new release through his official Twitter account. It is touted to come ‘with a lot of awesome fixes’ to deliver an upgraded development experience.

Ubuntu Make 16.05 debuts as a new maintenance release of the open source CLI tool that was previously known as Ubuntu Developer Tools Center. It is designed to help developers work on third-party SDKs and IDEs right from an Ubuntu machine.

To offer an advanced Android development platform, Ubuntu Make 16.05 adds OpenJDK 8 to the improved Android SDK. However, the dependency on OpenJDK for the Arduino IDE has been removed.

Roche has provided support for the Netbeans IDE to let you install the new Ubuntu Make version right on your Ubuntu 16.04 LTS running system. Also, there is a fix for some local issues within tests.

You can install Ubuntu Make 16.05 on Xenial Xerus directly from GitHub. In addition to the latest version, the new Ubuntu Make can be installed on Ubuntu 14.04 LTS (Trusty Tahr) and Ubuntu 15.10 (Wily Werewolf). You need to enter a repository command to enable the installation on a previous Ubuntu machine.